

Best practices for designing an AI Use Policy

As organizations begin to leverage generative AI, building an AI Use Policy can ensure that your team is best positioned to innovate responsibly with AI. The following guide highlights best practices, key elements, and additional resources for political organizations as they build their AI Use Policy.

Getting started



Learn about generative AI: Get to know what generative AI is, its possible uses, challenges, and advantages.



Identify organizational goals: Discuss how your organization plans to use generative AI whether it be for content creation, automation, data analysis, or other purposes.



Explore the regulatory environment: Investigate the legal and regulatory obligations related to generative AI in your industry and jurisdiction.



Define purpose and scope of the acceptable usage of generative AI: Determine not only the limits and aims of the policy, but also what specific types of AI (i.e. generative AI) the policy applies to.



Review existing policies: Look at your relevant policies to ensure alignment and clarity.

Building blocks of an AI Use Policy



Principles & values

Establish the principles and values that guide your AI use. These same principles and values will help define the scope of the policy. When drafting your principles, consider the following:

- What are the ethical and moral standards that you adhere to when using AI?
- How do you ensure that your AI use is fair, transparent, explainable, and accountable?
- How is human oversight, judgment, and feedback incorporated into your AI use?
- How do you communicate and explain your AI use and outputs to your stakeholders and/or the public?



Scope & purpose

Based on your organization's AI principles, define the scope and purpose of your AI policy. The scope can incorporate elements such as your core use cases and larger goal(s) for leveraging AI.

- What are the goals and objectives of your AI use?
- What are the AI services, features, and functionality that you use or plan to use?
- Who are the intended users and beneficiaries of your AI applications?
- How does your AI use align with your organizational mission and values?



Benefits & risks

Identify the potential risks and benefits of your organization's generative AI use. The potential benefits and risks you state in this section will directly inform the acceptable AI practices that you outline later on in the policy.

- What are the possible positive and negative impacts of your AI use?
- How do you measure and evaluate the performance and outcomes of your AI applications?
- How do you address and mitigate the risks and harms of your AI use (such as data privacy, security, accuracy, and unintended consequences)?

Building blocks of an AI Use Policy



Dos & don'ts of AI use

Develop policies and practices that not only address the benefits and risks of your AI use, but are reflective of your stated AI principles and values. This can include:

- What are the specific rules and guidelines that you follow when using AI?
- What AI tools and applications are you comfortable using to ensure compliance with your organization's data security policies?
- When can your organization use public generative AI tools and are there specific restrictions when using these public tools?
- Are there specific disclosure and labelling practices you want staff using for AI-generated content?
- How do you select and vet your AI vendors and data suppliers?
- How do you monitor and audit the quality and accuracy of your AI outputs?



Share your policy

Once completed, build a plan to share and publish your policy. This includes determining how you will communicate and disclose your policy with stakeholders, staff and/or the public. From there, it's important to consider:

- How do you demonstrate and report on your compliance and adherence to your policy?
- How do you train and educate your staff on responsible AI use and the policy you developed?
- How do you review and update your policy as needed in the future?